

VS Code 1.110

February 2026 – Technical Deep Dive

Making agents practical for longer-running, complex tasks

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Release Highlights

-  **Agent Plugins** – installable bundles of skills, tools, hooks
-  **Agentic Browser Tools** – agent drives browser autonomously
-  **Session Memory & Forking** – plans persist, conversations branch
-  **Agent Debug Panel** – real-time visibility into agent events
-  **Long-distance NES** – edit predictions anywhere in file
-  **Kitty Graphics Protocol** – images in terminal
-  **Unified JS/TS Settings** – `js/ts.*` prefix for TypeScript 6/7
-  **Python Environments GA** – unified env management

Agent Controls

Background Agents & Claude Agents

Background Agents

- **Context compaction:** manual `/compact` command for background agents
- **Slash commands:** prompt files, hooks, and skills now available via `/` commands
- **Session rename:** rename background agent sessions for tracking

Claude Agents (v1.109 → v1.110)

- **Steering & queuing:** send follow-ups mid-conversation
- `getDiagnostics` **tool:** agent accesses editor problems
- **Slash commands:** `/compact`, `/agents`, `/hooks`
- Significant performance improvements (unspecified benchmarks)

Agent Debug Panel

Agent Debug Panel (*Preview*)

- Real-time visibility into chat events, tool calls, system prompts
- Replaces old **Diagnostics** chat action
- **Flow chart view**: visual hierarchy of agent events

Access

- Command Palette → **Developer: Open Agent Debug Panel**
- Chat view gear icon → **View Agent Logs**

⚠ Local sessions only – logs not persisted across VS Code restarts

Auto Approval & Mode Changes

Auto Approval – `/yolo` Mode

- `/autoApprove` or `/yolo` – enable global auto approve
- `/disableAutoApprove` or `/disableYolo` – disable
- ⚠ Skips all tool confirmation prompts – combine with terminal sandboxing

Edit Mode Deprecated

- Edit Mode **hidden by default** (`chat.editMode.hidden`)
- Agent Mode now handles everything edit mode did
- Ask Mode reimplemented as a **custom agent definition**
- **Removal timeline:** v1.125 (approx. 15 releases)

askQuestions Tool & Auto-Suspend

askQuestions Tool → Core

- Moved from extension into VS Code core
- Reliable cancellation, consistent subagent behavior
- Steering messages work without dismissing pending questions
- Navigate: `Alt+N` (next) / `Alt+P` (previous)

Prevent Auto-Suspend

- OS asked not to suspend during active chat requests
- Long-running agent tasks won't be interrupted
- Closing unplugged laptop lid still triggers suspension

Agent Extensibility

Agent Plugins Architecture

Agent Plugins (*Experimental*)

Prepackaged bundles: **skills + commands + agents + MCP servers + hooks**

Setting	Purpose
<code>chat.plugins.enabled</code>	Enable/disable plugin system

Discovery

- Extensions view → search `@agentPlugins`
- Command Palette → **Chat: Plugins**
- Default sources: `copilot-plugins`, `awesome-copilot`
- Cross-vendor: supports `anthropics/claude-code` repos

Agentic Browser Tools

Agentic Browser Tools (*Experimental*)

10 tools for autonomous browser interaction:

Category	Tools
Navigation	<code>openBrowserPage</code> , <code>navigatePage</code>
Content	<code>readPage</code> , <code>screenshotPage</code>
Interaction	<code>clickElement</code> , <code>hoverElement</code> , <code>dragElement</code> , <code>typeInPage</code> , <code>handleDialog</code>

- No extra dependencies required
- Private in-memory sessions by default (explicit sharing for data access)
- Enable: `workbench.browser.enableChatTools`

/create-* Commands

Generate agent customizations directly from conversation:

- `/create-prompt` – reusable prompt file
- `/create-instruction` – project convention rules
- `/create-skill` – multi-step workflow package
- `/create-agent` – specialized custom agent
- `/create-hook` – lifecycle automation config

Key Details

- Choose **user-level** or **workspace-level** storage
- Extract patterns from ongoing conversations
- Natural language: *"save this workflow as a skill"*

LSP-Backed Agent Tools

Tools for `usages` & `rename`

- Updated `usages` tool + new `rename` tool
- Reuses **existing LSP capabilities** – precise, high-performance
- Outperforms grep-based approaches for refactoring

Agent Behavior Note

- Agents strongly prefer grep over LSP tools
- **Workaround:** explicitly `#rename` mention in prompt
- Or configure via `SKILL.md` file

Smarter Sessions

Session Memory for Plans

- Plans persist to **session memory** across conversation turns
- Survives unrelated messages and context compaction
- No need to re-provide plan context in long sessions

Manual Context Compaction

- Type `/compact` in chat input (local, background, Claude sessions)
- Add custom instructions: `/compact focus on the database schema`
- Also via context window control → **Compact Conversation**

Note: Compaction summarizes history – some information loss is inherent

Explore Subagent & Session Forking

Explore Subagent

- Plan agent delegates codebase research to **Explore** subagent
- Read-only: search + file read tools only
- Default models: **Claude Haiku 4.5**, **Gemini 3 Flash** (fast)
- Override: `chat.exploreAgent.defaultModel`
- Not directly invocable – subagent only

Session Forking

- `/fork` – full session history fork
- **Fork Conversation** hover action – fork from checkpoint
- Forked sessions are fully independent

Inline Chat Integration

Inline Chat → Agent Session

- Inline chat now **queues into active agent session** when file was already modified
- Ensures full context is used – no isolated changes
- Useful when reviewing agent edits

Benefit

Before: Inline edit creates independent change (no agent context)

After: Inline edit joins agent session (full context preserved)

Chat UX

Model Picker & Tips

Redesigned Model Picker

- **Auto** – always at top
- **Featured + Recently Used** – up to 4 recent models
- **Other Models** – collapsible, with **Manage Models**
- Search box for filtering by name
- Rich hover: capabilities, context window size

Contextual Tips (*Experimental*)

- `chat.tips.enabled` – tailored feature suggestions
- Only suggests features you haven't tried
- Auto-hides after you use the feature

Collapsible Terminal Tool Calls

- Agent terminal output displayed as **collapsible sections**
- Expand for full output – reduces visual noise
- Setting: `chat.tools.terminal.simpleCollapsible`

OS Notifications

- `chat.notifyWindowOnResponseReceived`: `always` for in-focus
- `chat.notifyWindowOnConfirmation`: `always` for in-focus

Inline Chat Evolution

- **Hover mode:** `inlineChat.renderMode`: `hover` – floating UI
 - **Affordance:** `inlineChat.affordance` – `editor` / `gutter` / `off`
- February 2026 Release | March 4, 2026 Custom thinking phrases: `chat.agent.thinking.phrases`

Accessibility

10+ Accessibility Improvements

Accessibility – AI Interaction

Feature	Detail
Thinking content toggle	Toggle model reasoning in accessible view
Question carousel	Position announcements, Alt+N/P navigation
TODO list focus	<code>Ctrl+Shift+T</code> toggles TODO ↔ chat input
Chat notifications	Signal + OS notification on questions/confirmations

- **Accessibility skill:** built-in skill for a11y-first feature creation
- **Checkmarks hidden:** `accessibility.chat.showCheckmarks` (default: off)
- **Steering indicator:** `aria-status` announcement on steering

Editor & Code Editing

Modal Editors & Long-Distance NES

Modal Editors (*Experimental*)

- Floating editors for Settings, Keyboard Shortcuts, Profiles, AI Models
- `workbench.editor.useModal: some`
- `extensions.allowOpenInModalEditor` – extends to extensions
- Press `Escape` to close; action to move back to tab

Long-Distance NES

- NES now predicts edits **anywhere in your file**
- Enable: `github.copilot.nextEditSuggestions.enabled` + `.extendedRange`
- **Eagerness control** in Copilot Status Bar: precision ↔ recall
- Currently affects timing; model will incorporate eagerness preference

Notification Position & Settings Cleanup

Workbench Improvements

Notification Position

- `workbench.notifications.position` : `top-right` / `bottom-right` / `bottom-left`
- Resolves conflict with Chat view on the right side

Settings Editor Cleanup

- Chat settings → own **top-level entry** with sub-categories
- TOC scoping – no accidental scroll into next section
- Experimental settings moved to **end of each section**

Source Control & Debugging

AI Co-Author Attribution

- - `git.addAICoAuthor` :
 - `off` (default) – no trailer
 - `chatAndAgent` – Copilot Chat / Agent Mode
 - `all` – including inline completions
- Git blame hover shows co-author trailers
- VS Code commits only – not external Git tools

JavaScript Debugger

- **Custom properties:** `Symbol.for( 'debug.properties' )` for clean object views
- **Browser Options** (renamed from Event Listener Breakpoints)
- **Emulate focused page:** debug hover/focus-dependent elements

Terminal

Kitty Graphics Protocol

Kitty Graphics Protocol

High-fidelity image rendering in the terminal:

Capability	Details
Formats	PNG, 24-bit RGB, 32-bit RGBA
Layout	Column/row scaling, sub-cell offsets, z-index
Transfer	Inline base64, chunked, zlib compression
Management	Store & place, delete by ID, re-transmit

Enable: `terminal.integrated.enableImages: true` + `gpuAcceleration: on`

Windows also needs: `terminal.integrated.windowsUseConptyDll: true`

Ghostty & Terminal Sandboxing

Ghostty + External Terminals

- **Ghostty** supported on macOS/Linux as external terminal
- `terminal.external.osxExec: "Ghostty.app"` (macOS)
- `terminal.external.linuxExec: "ghostty"` (Linux)
- **Multi-root workspace:** folder selection prompt for external terminals

Terminal Sandboxing (*Preview*)

- `chat.tools.terminal.sandbox.network:` `allowTrustedDomains`
- Improved restricted domain detection + clear feedback
- **macOS:** no install required
- **Linux:** no ripgrep dependency needed

Languages

Unified JS/TS Settings

js/ts.* – Unified Settings

Preparing for TypeScript 6.0 / 7.0:

Before (duplicate settings):

```
"javascript.format.enable": false,
```

After (language-specific overrides):

```
"[javascript][javascriptreact]": {
```

- Old `javascript.*` / `typescript.*` settings **deprecated** (still work, but overridden)
- Removal timeline: not stated

Python Environments (GA)

Rolling out to all users after 1 year in preview:

- **Quick Create:** 1-click environment with default manager
- **Python Projects:** per-folder env assignment for monorepos
- **uv integration:** faster env creation and package install
- **Package management:** search/install/uninstall from UI
- **Portable settings:** manager types instead of hardcoded paths

Opt-in

- `python.useEnvsExtension: true` for immediate access
- Gradual automatic rollout over coming weeks

Extension API & Engineering

APIs & Build System

Finalized APIs

- `env.isAppPortable` – detect portable mode (stable, no `enabledApiProposals`)
- **ThemeIcon for Webviews** – `webviewPanel.iconPath = new ThemeIcon('octoface')`

Proposed API

- **Chat item controller** – `ChatSessionItemControllerNewItemHandler`, `newSessionOptions`
- Performance optimized for large session counts

Engineering

- **TypeScript-Go (tsgo)**: default for VS Code workspace, sub-second extension compilation
- **esbuild migration**: webpack → esbuild for built-in extensions (nearly complete)

Deprecations

Edit Mode Timeline

Edit Mode – Deprecation Schedule

Version	Status
v1.109	Edit Mode available (last full release)
v1.110	Hidden by default (<code>chat.editMode.hidden</code>)

Migration Path

1. Agent Mode handles all edit mode capabilities
2. **View edit agent** action → see the agent definition powering edit mode
3. Create a custom agent replicating preferred behaviors
4. Learn: [custom agents documentation](#)

New Settings Reference (1/2)

Setting	Section	Status
<code>chat.plugins.enabled</code>	Agent Plugins	Experimental
<code>chat.plugins.marketplaces</code>	Agent Plugins	Experimental
<code>workbench.browser.enableChatTools</code>	Browser Tools	Experimental
<code>chat.exploreAgent.defaultModel</code>	Explore Subagent	GA
<code>chat.tips.enabled</code>	Chat Tips	Experimental
<code>chat.agent.thinking.phrases</code>	Thinking Phrases	GA
<code>chat.tools.terminal.simpleCollapsible</code>	Terminal Output	GA

New Settings Reference (2/2)

Setting	Section	Status
<code>inlineChat.renderMode</code>	Inline Chat	GA
<code>inlineChat.affordance</code>	Inline Chat	GA
<code>workbench.editor.useModal</code>	Modal Editors	Experimental
<code>workbench.notifications.position</code>	Notifications	GA
<code>git.addAICoAuthor</code>	Source Control	GA
<code>terminal.integrated.enableImages</code>	Kitty Graphics	GA
<code>chat.tools.terminal.sandbox.enabled</code>	Sandboxing	Preview

Key Takeaways

1.  **Agent Plugins** create a new distribution model for AI capabilities – cross-vendor, installable, composable
2.  **Browser tools** close the authoring-verification loop – agents can build AND test web apps autonomously
3.  **Session management** matured significantly – persistent plans, manual compaction, forking
4.  **Edit Mode deprecated** – migrate to agent mode or create custom agent before v1.125
5.  **JS/TS settings unified** under `js/ts.*` – migrate now for TypeScript 6/7 readiness
6.  **tsgo + esbuild** adoption signals next-gen tooling commitment

Thank You

 Full release notes: code.visualstudio.com/updates/v1_110

 Blog: [Long-distance NES](#)

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